

Interview Question Bank

Behavioral and situational questions organized by competency. Ask the same questions, in the same order, to every candidate for the role.

Problem solving

- Walk me through the most complex problem you've solved in the last year. What made it hard, and what did you actually do?
- Imagine you inherit a project that's behind schedule and the original owner is gone. What are your first three moves?
- Tell me about a time the obvious solution was wrong. How did you figure that out?
- Describe a problem you solved with far fewer resources than you needed.

Communication

- Tell me about a time you had to explain something technical or complicated to someone who disagreed with you.
- If you had to give this team one piece of difficult feedback after your first month, how would you deliver it?
- Describe a time a message you sent landed badly. What did you do next?
- Tell me about persuading someone senior to change course.

Ownership

- Describe a time something failed and it was at least partly your fault. What happened afterward?
- Tell me about a time you did work nobody asked you to do. Why did you do it?
- Describe the moment you realized a commitment you'd made couldn't be met. What did you do in the first 24 hours?
- What is something broken in your current/last role that you fixed without being told to?

Adaptability

- Tell me about a time priorities changed suddenly under you. What did you keep, and what did you drop?
- What's a strongly held opinion about your work you've reversed in the last two years?
- Describe joining a team or company whose way of working conflicted with yours.
- Tell me about learning a skill under deadline pressure.

Collaboration

- Tell me about a conflict with a colleague where you were partly wrong.
- Describe a time you helped a teammate succeed at cost to your own workload.
- Tell me about working closely with someone whose style was opposite to yours.
- Describe a decision your team made that you disagreed with. What did you do after it was made?

Leadership (for senior roles)

- Tell me about the hardest personnel decision you've made.
- Describe raising the bar on a team that was comfortable.
- Tell me about a time you delegated something important and it went wrong.
- How did you decide what NOT to do last quarter? Walk me through a real example.

Probing follow-ups (use on any question)

- What did YOU do — specifically?
- What happened in the first hour / first day?
- What would you do differently now?
- How do you know it worked? What did you measure?

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